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Immigration raids roil key industries

Economists fear widespread disruption as sectors struggle to replace employees

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

At least 80 immigrant workers have been fired at Logan Airport. Nearly 50 foreign-born Market Basket employees were suspended in New Bedford. Around the state, painters, roofers, and drywallers

have been arrested; health care researchers, pizza makers, and hardwood floor installers have been thrown in detention.

The Trump administration's crackdown on undocumented immigrants, including those with legal work authorization permits

that have been revoked, and some with asylum claims pending, could take a major toll on a workforce that's already stretched to the limit. Immigrants make up nearly 20 percent of the country's labor force — around 5 percent are undocumented — and economists say the administration's goal to deport 4 million people over the next four years could lead to widespread disruption if a sharply reduced labor

supply threatens employers' ability to stay afloat.

In Massachusetts, 148,000 jobs could be lost, including roles held by immigrants with work permits and by US-born workers, according to the Economic Policy Institute.

This culling of the workforce, alongside tariffs and other uncertainty, will cause the economy to contract, said Tarek Hassan, a Bos-

IMMIGRANT WORKFORCE, Page A7

Trump takes over D.C. police agency

Citing crime, he mobilizes National Guard, despite falling numbers in city

By Katie Rogers
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump on Monday took federal control of the police force in the nation's capital for 30 days and mobilized 800 National Guard troops to fight crime in a city that he claimed was overrun with “bloodthirsty criminals,” even though crime numbers in Washington are falling.

During a 78-minute news conference, during which he was flanked by several members of his Cabinet, Trump took to the lectern in the White House briefing room and said he also intended to clear out the capital's homeless population, without saying how officials would do it, or detailing where those people would go.

Armed with papers that showed crime statistics, Trump decried murders in Washington compared with other global cities but ignored the fact that violent crime has fallen recently in the nation's capital. While the violent crime rate surged in 2023, it fell 35 percent from that year to 2024, according to the city's Metropolitan Police Department.

Instead, Trump painted Washington as an urban hellscape, repurposing some of the incendiary language he has used to describe conditions at the

WASHINGTON , Page A6



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

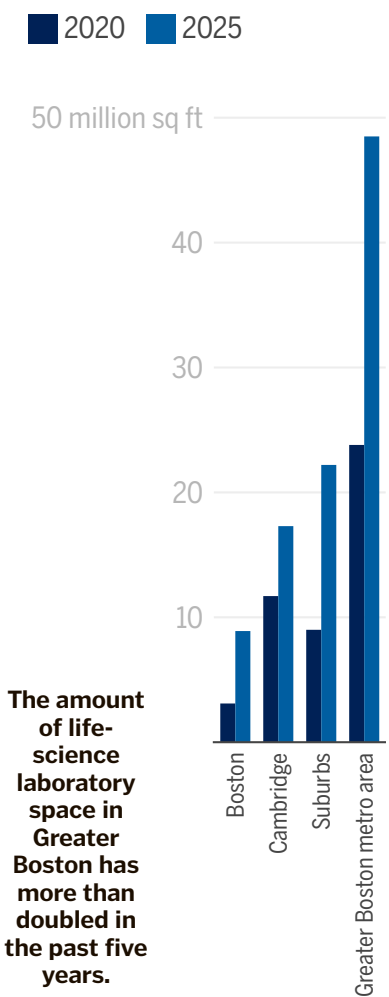


Chart: DANA GERBER/GLOBE STAFF • Source: Newmark



The lab building at 74M in Somerville has many great features, including expansive views. What it does not have, yet, are tenants. At left, labs need extensive duct work.

36%
of new area lab space is empty
\$85/sq. ft.
rent for a new lab in Greater Boston, versus around \$50 on average for office space

Vacancy rates for laboratory space are at record highs. But reusing it is complicated — and pricey.

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

On the 16th-story amenities floor of a new building in Somerville known as 74M, cobalt blue couches and a wall of Skee-Ball games lead to an outdoor patio with commanding views of downtown Boston. The lobby has a sculpture of conjoined Slinky toys that's 57 feet tall, and the building itself is just steps from the Assembly Row shopping development and an Orange Line station.

Yes, 74M has all the markings of so many buildings that have sprouted all over Greater Boston during the last decade.

The trouble is, like more than a few of them, 74M was built for life science labs. And aside from a soon-to-open Dunkin' on the ground

floor, it is empty. So is a 500,000-square-foot lab building up the street, as well as one in Boston near Fenway Park. A sprawling complex on Western Ave. in Allston has some retailers, but no lab tenants.

After a COVID-era building boom, the amount of lab space in Greater Boston has roughly doubled in the last five years, to 48.4 million square feet. Yet, in a striking instance of mistiming, the once-metabolic growth of the biomedical industry here has essentially stagnated, to the point where nearly 36 percent of that lab space is empty, according to brokerage firm Newmark. That's the highest vacancy rate on record.

The glut of space is particularly striking at a time when Greater Boston faces a massive

EMPTY LABS, Page A10

Teachers' union seeks influence in local votes

MTA set to stockpile \$1m for supportive candidates

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

The state's largest teachers union has racked up a number of impressive wins in recent years: successful campaigns to eliminate high school graduation requirements and to raise taxes on the wealthy, and a series of local strikes that resulted in pay raises and new benefits for its members.

And now the Massachusetts Teachers Association is gearing up to become an even bigger player in local politics.

Union leaders recently voted to set aside \$1 million to spend on municipal elections such as school board and mayoral races. The money will be used to help campaign for union-backed candidates as soon as this fall.

The move represents the union's decision to take a bigger role in hyperlocal politics in a “culmination” of years of building local union efforts, said MTA president Max Page. The association intends to support candidates who win the endorsement of local chapters, amid widespread fights for higher wages for teachers and paraprofessionals, paid family leave, and other benefits.

TEACHERS, Page A10

Market Basket board warns Demoulas on rise of ‘public vitriol’

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

A lawyer for Market Basket's board has issued a stern warning to sidelined chief executive Arthur T. Demoulas, accusing him of orchestrating a PR campaign to ratchet up “public vitriol” against the directors and the company's majority shareholders, Demoulas's three sisters.

The board put Demoulas and several allies and family members on paid administrative leave in late May while its law firm Quinn Emanuel investigates rumors that he might have been planning a work disruption to protect his job. Demoulas and the board had been at odds, with the board saying the CEO needed to share more budget information and bring more managers to its meetings. The investigation is close to completion and the two sides are planning to meet on Sept. 3 for a mediation session.

On Friday, Quinn Emanuel partner Harvey Wolkoff sent a

MARKET BASKET, Page A7

AN OASIS IN THE HARBOR



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

The National Park Service opened Spectacle Island, one of the Boston Harbor Islands, to overnight campers for one night earlier this month. The experience, some participants said, was terrific. **B1.**


Warmest regards

Tuesday: Stifling.
High 90-95, low 69-74.
Wednesday: Hot, some breeze.
High 91-96, low 72-77.
Sunrise: 5:48. Sunset: 7:49.
Weather and comics, **D5-6.**
Obituaries, **C9.**
VOL. 308, NO. 43
*
Suggested retail price
\$4.00

Ukraine joined with its European backers in calling for talks with President Trump as concerns grew that he would support allowing Russia to keep some land from its invasion. **A3.**

Baylor University is suing Boston University over its use of an interlocking BU logo that Baylor says infringes on its historic trademarks. **B1.**

Governor Maura Healey expressed concern over the extortion charges levied against Suffolk Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins but declined to call for his resignation. **B1.**

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